VENVLEARNING

TEACHER EDITION



Social Studies

GRADE 4

Guided lessons, pacing, and complete answer keys

2026–2027 School Year · Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

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Grade 4
Social Studies

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2026–2027 School Year

Unit 1 Mississippi: Land and Regions

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this Teacher Edition

This book holds everything needed to teach the course: unit overviews, a plan for every lesson with what to say and do, the student lesson with Try It answers, and answer keys for every workbook page, weekly check and unit test.

- Daily routine (about 45–55 minutes): Warm-Up 5 · Read and Discuss 15 · Analyze 10 · Guided Practice 7 · Independent 10 · Exit Ticket 3.
- Say: lines are a suggested script. Use your own words.
- Tuesday and Thursday are lessons. Friday is the Weekly Check (about 15 minutes), then corrections or a project.
- Dates match the VenvLearning lesson plans for the 2026–2027 school year.

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UNIT 1 · TEACHER OVERVIEW

Mississippi: Land and Regions

Map skills, location, landforms and rivers, natural regions, resources, and regional economies.

From the flat, fertile Delta to the pine forests and the Gulf Coast, Mississippi is a state of many landscapes. In this unit you'll learn to read maps like a geographer, find Mississippi's place in the world, explore its rivers and regions, and discover how its natural resources shape the way people live and work.

Big ideas

- Read maps using the title, compass rose, key, and scale.
- Describe Mississippi's relative and absolute location.
- Identify landforms, waterways, and natural regions.
- Classify natural resources and explain how they shape regional economies.

Standards

Code	Standard
C3 D2.Geo.1–4	Maps; places and regions; human–environment interaction.
C3 D2.Eco.3	Resources used to produce goods and services.

What students should already know

- Cardinal directions.

Materials for the unit

- Globe or world map
- Mississippi road map (optional)
- Salt dough materials
- Index cards, poster paper

Pacing calendar

Week	Day	Lesson	Title
Week of Oct 26	Tue 10/27	1.1	Maps and Globes
Week of Oct 26	Thu 10/29	1.2	Where in the World Is Mississippi?
Week of Oct 26	Fri 10/30	Check	Weekly Check 1: Maps and Location
Week of Nov 2	Tue 11/3	1.3	Mississippi's Land and Water
Week of Nov 2	Thu 11/5	1.4	Reading Physical and Political Maps
Week of Nov 2	Fri 11/6	Check	Weekly Check 2: Land and Water
Week of Nov 9	Tue 11/10	1.5	Mississippi's Natural Regions
Week of Nov 9	Thu 11/12	1.6	Comparing the Delta and the Piney Woods
Week of Nov 9	Fri 11/13	Check	Weekly Check 3: Regions
Week of Nov 16	Tue 11/17	1.7	Natural Resources
Week of Nov 16	Thu 11/19	1.8	Resources and Work in Each Region
Week of Nov 16	Fri 11/20	Test	Unit 1 Test

TEACHING THIS UNIT AT HOME

On your next drive, look at a map together before you leave and track your route, directions, and the rivers you cross.

UNIT VOCABULARY

compass rose	Shows directions on a map.
latitude	Lines measuring distance north or south of the equator.
region	An area with shared features.
natural resource	Something from nature people use.
goods	Things made or grown to sell.
services	Work done for others.

LESSON 1.1 · TEACHER PLAN
Planned for Tuesday, October 27

Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.1: Maps and Globes

Student goal	I can use a map's title, compass rose, key, and scale to read a map.
Objective	Students use map parts to read a map.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.1.3-5 — Construct maps and other representations of familiar places.
Date	Tue Oct 27
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 1.1, paper, ruler, colored pencils
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Directions to a park.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and the Mississippi map.
Analyze	10	Model each map part. Measure Jackson to Gulfport with the scale.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Assuming north is always “up” on every map without checking the compass rose.

SUPPORT

- Map-part sticky labels.

EXTEND

- Map your neighborhood.

STUDENT LESSON 1.1 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.1: Maps and Globes

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.1 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Map My Room.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.1 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

If you had to give a friend directions from your house to a park, what would you draw?

A globe is a model of Earth, so it shows shapes and distances correctly, but it's hard to carry and you can only see half at a time. A map is a flat drawing of a place. Maps can show a whole country or one small neighborhood.

Map part	What it tells you
title	what the map shows
compass rose	directions: north (N), south (S), east (E), west (W), and in-between directions like northeast (NE)
map key (legend)	what each symbol, line, or color means
scale	how far apart places really are

This map's title tells you it shows cities of Mississippi. The star marks Jackson, the state capital, and dots mark other cities.

The compass rose in the top corner points north. The scale bar at the bottom stands for 50 miles. Rivers are drawn in blue.

Notice that the Mississippi River traces most of the state's western edge, and the southern coast meets the Gulf of Mexico.

Cities of Mississippi



LOOK CLOSER · USE THE SCALE

About how far is it from Jackson to Gulfport?

1 Measure the distance on the map with a strip of paper.

2 Compare it with the scale bar (50 miles).

3 The distance is about three scale bars long.

Answer: about 150 miles

ACTIVITY · MAP MY ROOM

Can you make a map someone else could use?

You need: paper; ruler; colored pencils.

1 Draw your bedroom or kitchen as if you were looking down from the ceiling.

2 Add a title and a compass rose (find north with a compass app or the sunrise in the east).

3 Make a key with at least four symbols.

4 Add a scale such as “1 inch = 2 feet.”

Record: your finished map; trade with a family member and ask them to find something using only the map.

★ KEY IDEA

Read the title, check the compass rose, use the key, and measure with the scale.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Which map part explains symbols?

Answer: the map key (legend)

2. Which direction is between north and east?

Answer: northeast

3. Which city is the state capital?

Answer: Jackson

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.1

#	Question	Answer
1	Which map part explains symbols?	the map key (legend)
2	Which direction is between north and east?	northeast
3	Which city is the state capital?	Jackson
4	The four cardinal directions	north, south, east, west
5	A round model of Earth	globe
6	Use the map for questions 3–7. Which city is farthest north? (figure)	Southaven
7	Which two cities are on the Gulf of Mexico?	Gulfport and Biloxi
8	In which direction would you travel from Jackson to Meridian?	east
9	In which direction from Tupelo is Hattiesburg?	south (slightly southwest)
10	Which river forms Mississippi's western border?	the Mississippi River
11	Name the four map parts and tell what each one does.	Title: what the map shows; compass rose: directions; key: symbols; scale: distance.

LESSON 1.2 · TEACHER PLAN
Planned for Thursday, October 29

Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.2: Where in the World Is Mississippi?

Student goal	I can describe Mississippi's location using relative location, hemispheres, and latitude and longitude.
Objective	Students describe relative and absolute location.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Use maps to explain relationships between locations of places.
Date	Thu Oct 29
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Globe or world map, workbook Lesson 1.2
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Describe home to someone far away.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; examine both maps.
Analyze	10	Teach latitude/longitude and hemispheres.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. Weekly Check Friday.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Mixing up latitude and longitude.

SUPPORT

- "Lat is flat" memory trick.

EXTEND

- Find the coordinates of a favorite vacation spot.

STUDENT LESSON 1.2 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.2: Where in the World Is Mississippi?

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.2 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Grid Hunt.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.2 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

How would you describe where you live to someone on the other side of the world?

Relative location describes a place by what is near it. Mississippi is in the southern United States. It borders Tennessee to the north, Alabama to the east, the Gulf of Mexico and Louisiana to the south, and Louisiana and Arkansas to the west, across the Mississippi River.



Mississippi is highlighted.

Absolute location uses a grid of imaginary lines. Lines of latitude measure degrees north or south of the equator. Lines of longitude measure degrees east or west of the prime meridian.

Because Mississippi is north of the equator and west of the prime meridian, it is in the Northern and Western Hemispheres. Jackson is at about 32° N, 90° W.



Latitude labels at left; longitude labels at bottom.

ACTIVITY · GRID HUNT

Can you find places using latitude and longitude?

You need: a globe or world map with latitude and longitude lines; paper and a pencil.

1. Find 30° N, 90° W. What place is near there?
2. Find the equator and the prime meridian.
3. Find a place in each of the four hemispheres.
4. Make up two coordinates and challenge a family member to find them.

Record: each coordinate and the place you found.

★ KEY IDEA

Relative location compares places; absolute location uses latitude and longitude. Mississippi is in the Northern and Western Hemispheres.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Which state borders Mississippi to the east?

Answer: Alabama

2. Which body of water is south of Mississippi?

Answer: the Gulf of Mexico

3. Which hemispheres is Mississippi in?

Answer: Northern and Western

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.2

#	Question	Answer
1	Which state borders Mississippi to the east?	Alabama
2	Which body of water is south of Mississippi?	the Gulf of Mexico
3	Which hemispheres is Mississippi in?	Northern and Western
4	Lines that run east–west	latitude
5	Half of Earth is a...	hemisphere
6	State north of Mississippi	Tennessee
7	Two states west of Mississippi	Louisiana and Arkansas
8	Jackson's approximate latitude	32° N
9	Is Mississippi north or south of the equator?	north
10	Relative or absolute: “Jackson is about 32° N, 90° W.”	absolute
11	Relative or absolute: “Gulfport is on the Gulf of Mexico.”	relative
12	Describe Mississippi's relative location in two sentences.	e.g. Mississippi is in the southern U.S. between Louisiana and Alabama, with Tennessee to the north and the Gulf of Mexico to the south.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
Planned for Fri Oct 30
About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 1: Maps and Location — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Which map part shows directions?	compass rose
2	Which map part explains symbols?	map key (legend)
3	What does a scale show?	real distance
4	Which state is east of Mississippi?	Alabama
5	Which hemispheres is Mississippi in?	Northern and Western
6	Relative or absolute: “32° N, 90° W”	absolute

LESSON 1.3 · TEACHER PLAN
Planned for Tuesday, November 3

Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.3: Mississippi's Land and Water

Student goal	I can identify Mississippi's major landforms and waterways and explain why they matter.
Objective	Students identify landforms and waterways.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Use maps to explain relationships between places and environmental characteristics.
Date	Tue Nov 3
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Tray, towel, water, pebbles, workbook Lesson 1.3
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Rivers flow south.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; trace rivers on the map.
Analyze	10	Discuss elevation and flow; waterways and trade.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking rivers always flow “down” the map (south) everywhere.

SUPPORT

- Highlight each river a different color.

EXTEND

- Research a Mississippi river's source.

STUDENT LESSON 1.3 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.3: Mississippi's Land and Water

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.3 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Which Way Does Water Flow?.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.3 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

Most of Mississippi's rivers flow toward the south. Why do you think that is?

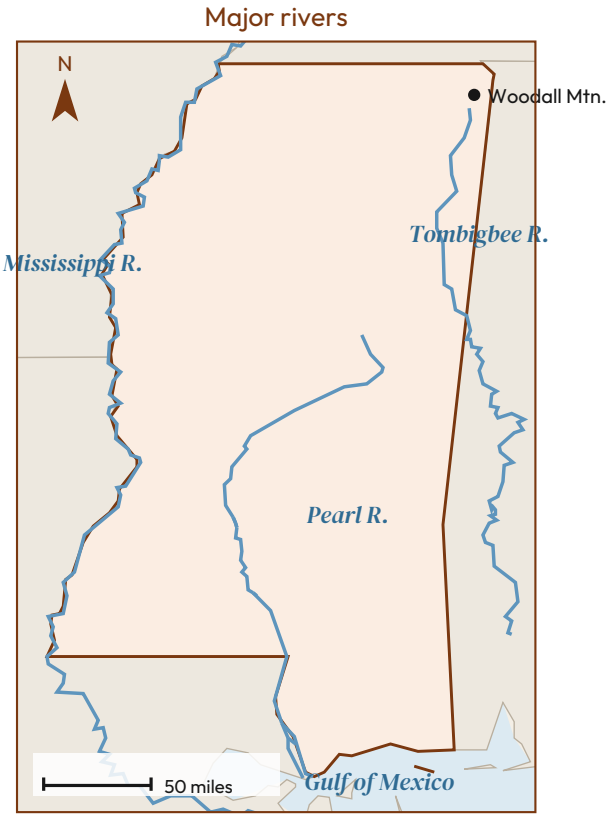
Mississippi is mostly low, rolling hills and flat plains. Its highest point is Woodall Mountain in the far northeast, about 806 feet above sea level. Its lowest point is sea level along the Gulf of Mexico. Because the land is generally higher in the north and lower in the south, most rivers flow south toward the Gulf.

Waterway	Fact
Mississippi River	Forms most of the state's western border; one of the longest rivers in North America
Yazoo River	Flows through the Delta into the Mississippi at Vicksburg
Pearl River	Flows past Jackson to the Gulf; part of it forms the border with Louisiana
Tombigbee River	Flows south through eastern Mississippi into Alabama
Pascagoula River	Flows into the Gulf at Pascagoula
Gulf of Mexico	Mississippi's southern coast, about 44 miles long

Waterways have always mattered to people here. Rivers provided fish, water, and travel routes for American Indian nations.

Later, steamboats carried cotton and goods on the Mississippi River.

Today, barges still move goods on the Mississippi and on the Tennessee-Tombigbee Waterway, a canal system opened in 1985 that connects the Tennessee River to the Tombigbee.



ACTIVITY · WHICH WAY DOES WATER FLOW?

How does the slope of land decide where rivers go?

You need: a baking sheet or tray; a towel to tilt it; a cup of water; a few pebbles.

1. Raise one end of the tray to make "high land" in the north.
2. Slowly pour water at the high end.
3. Watch which way it flows and where it collects.
4. Add pebbles as "hills" and observe how the water's path changes.

Record: a sketch showing high land, low land, and the water's path, and an explanation linked to Mississippi's rivers.

★ KEY IDEA

Mississippi's land is higher in the north and lower in the south, so most rivers flow south to the Gulf. Rivers have shaped travel, trade, and settlement.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. What is Mississippi's highest point?

Answer: Woodall Mountain (about 806 feet)

2. Which river forms most of the western border?

Answer: the Mississippi River

3. Why do most rivers flow south?

Answer: The land is higher in the north and lower in the south.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.3

#	Question	Answer
1	What is Mississippi's highest point?	Woodall Mountain (about 806 feet)
2	Which river forms most of the western border?	the Mississippi River
3	Why do most rivers flow south?	The land is higher in the north and lower in the south.
4	A large area of flat land	plain
5	A smaller river that flows into a larger one	tributary
6	Which river flows past Jackson?	the Pearl River
7	Where does the Yazoo River join the Mississippi?	at Vicksburg
8	What canal system connects the Tennessee and Tombigbee rivers?	the Tennessee-Tombigbee Waterway
9	What is Mississippi's lowest elevation?	sea level
10	Explain two ways rivers have been important to people in Mississippi.	e.g. fish and water; travel and trade by boat and barge.
11	Use the tray investigation to explain why the Pearl River flows to the Gulf.	Water flows downhill; the land slopes down toward the Gulf in the south.

LESSON 1.4 · TEACHER PLAN
Planned for Thursday, November 5

Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.4: Reading Physical and Political Maps

Student goal	I can tell physical and political maps apart and use each to answer questions.
Objective	Students compare physical and political maps.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.1.3-5 — Construct maps and other graphic representations.
Date	Thu Nov 5
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Salt dough materials, workbook Lesson 1.4
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Rivers vs cities.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; compare the maps.
Analyze	10	Model using two maps together.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. Weekly Check Friday.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking one map shows everything.

SUPPORT

- Sort questions into physical/political.

EXTEND

- Find your county on a Mississippi county map.

STUDENT LESSON 1.4 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.4: Reading Physical and Political Maps

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.4 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Salt Dough Relief Map.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.4 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

What's the difference between a map of the rivers in Mississippi and a map of its cities?

A physical map shows what nature made: rivers, hills, coastlines, and elevation, often with colors (green for low land, tan or brown for higher land). A political map shows what people decided: state and county boundaries, capitals, and cities. Mississippi is divided into 82 counties.

Question	Better map
Where is the state capital?	political
Where is the land highest?	physical
Which county is Tupelo in?	political
Which way does the Pearl River flow?	physical

LOOK CLOSER · USE TWO MAPS TOGETHER

Why did cities like Vicksburg and Natchez grow where they did?

1 Physical map: both sit on high bluffs beside the Mississippi River.

2 Political map: both are cities in western Mississippi.

3 Put them together: the high bluffs were safe from floods, and the river brought trade.

Answer: They grew on bluffs above the river, where people could trade by boat but stay above floodwaters.

ACTIVITY · SALT DOUGH RELIEF MAP

Can you build a physical map of Mississippi?

You need: outline of Mississippi traced on cardboard; salt dough (2 cups flour, 1 cup salt, about 3/4 cup water); paint; toothpick flags.

1. Spread a thin layer of dough over the outline.
2. Build it a little higher in the northeast and keep the Delta and coast flat.
3. Press a groove for the Mississippi and Pearl rivers.
4. When dry, paint low land green and higher land tan, and add flags for Jackson and your town.

Record: a photo or sketch of your map with a key.

★ KEY IDEA

Physical maps show natural features; political maps show boundaries and cities. Using both explains why places are where they are.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Which kind of map shows county lines?

Answer: political

2. Which kind shows elevation?

Answer: physical

3. How many counties does Mississippi have?

Answer: 82

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.4

#	Question	Answer
1	Which kind of map shows county lines?	political
2	Which kind shows elevation?	physical
3	How many counties does Mississippi have?	82
4	Height above sea level	elevation
5	Map that shows cities	political map
6	Find the route of the Yazoo River. Which map?	physical
7	Find the boundary between Mississippi and Alabama. Which map?	political
8	Find the flattest region. Which map?	physical
9	Find the nearest city to your home. Which map?	political

#	Question	Answer
10	Why might a city grow on a bluff next to a river?	Safe from floods but close to the river for water and trade.
11	Write one question a physical map can answer and one a political map can answer.	Answers vary.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
Planned for Fri Nov 6
About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 2: Land and Water — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Mississippi's highest point	Woodall Mountain
2	River on the western border	Mississippi River
3	River that flows past Jackson	Pearl River
4	Map that shows elevation	physical
5	Map that shows county lines	political
6	Why do most Mississippi rivers flow south?	The land is higher in the north and slopes down to the Gulf.

LESSON 1.5 · TEACHER PLAN
Planned for Tuesday, November 10
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.5: Mississippi's Natural Regions

Student goal	I can identify Mississippi's natural regions and describe the land in each.
Objective	Students identify Mississippi's natural regions.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Explain relationships between locations of places and regions and their environmental characteristics.
Date	Tue Nov 10
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Index cards, workbook Lesson 1.5
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Road trip changes.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; locate regions on the map.
Analyze	10	Discuss each region's land and soil.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking regions have sharp borders.

SUPPORT

- Color-coded region chart.

EXTEND

- Find photos of each region.

STUDENT LESSON 1.5 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.5: Mississippi's Natural Regions

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.5 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Region Postcards.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.5 (Parts B–D).

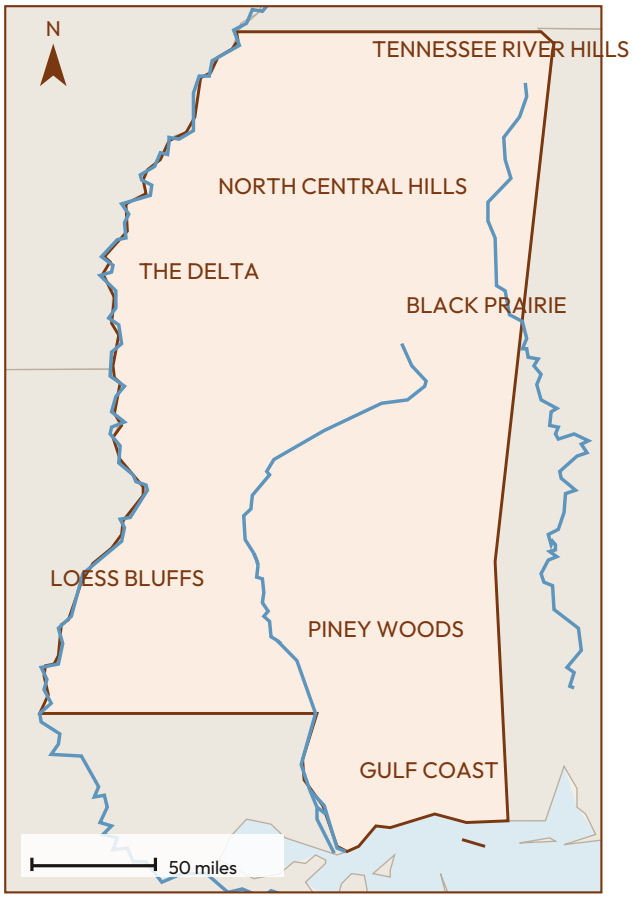
THINK ABOUT IT

If you drove from Tupelo to Greenville to Gulfport, how might the land outside your window change?

Geographers divide Mississippi into natural regions by land, soil, and plants.

Regions don't have sharp edges; one blends into the next. The labels on the map show where each region generally is.

As you read the chart below, find each region on the map.



General locations of Mississippi's natural regions.

Region	What the land is like
The Delta	very flat, fertile alluvial soil left by Mississippi and Yazoo river floods; northwest
Loess Bluffs	steep bluffs of fine wind-blown soil along the east edge of the Mississippi River valley
North Central Hills	rolling hills with red clay soil
Tennessee River Hills	the highest, most rugged land, in the far northeast
Black Prairie	gently rolling land with dark, rich soil in the northeast
Piney Woods	rolling hills with sandy soil and pine forests in the south
Gulf Coast	low, flat land with beaches, marshes, and bays along the Gulf of Mexico

ACTIVITY · REGION POSTCARDS

What would you see in each region?

You need: index cards; colored pencils.

1 Choose three regions.

2 On each card, draw a scene showing the land, plants, and one way people use the land.

3 On the back, write a short message describing the region to a friend.

Record: three postcards with accurate details.

★ KEY IDEA

Mississippi's regions include the Delta, Loess Bluffs, the hills, the Black Prairie, the Piney Woods, and the Gulf Coast, each with its own land and soil.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Which region is flattest and most fertile?

Answer: the Delta

2. Which region has pine forests?

Answer: the Piney Woods

3. Which region has the highest land?

Answer: the Tennessee River Hills

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.5

#	Question	Answer
1	Which region is flattest and most fertile?	the Delta
2	Which region has pine forests?	the Piney Woods
3	Which region has the highest land?	the Tennessee River Hills
4	Region =	an area with shared features
5	Soil left by rivers is...	alluvial
6	beaches and marshes	Gulf Coast
7	dark, rich soil in the northeast	Black Prairie
8	wind-blown soil bluffs	Loess Bluffs
9	red clay hills	North Central Hills
10	flat land between two rivers	the Delta
11	sandy soil and pines	Piney Woods
12	Which region do you live in or nearest to? Describe its land.	Answers vary.

LESSON 1.6 · TEACHER PLAN
Planned for Thursday, November 12
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.6: Comparing the Delta and the Piney Woods

Student goal	I can compare two regions and explain how land affects the way people live and work.
Objective	Students compare two regions.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.4.3-5 — Explain how people modify and adapt to their environments.
Date	Thu Nov 12
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 1.6
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Delta farm vs Piney Woods town.
Read and Discuss	15	Read both descriptions.
Analyze	10	Model one Venn entry each.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. Weekly Check Friday.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Listing facts without comparing.

SUPPORT

- Compare/contrast word bank.

EXTEND

- Interview a relative who lived in another region.

STUDENT LESSON 1.6 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.6: Comparing the Delta and the Piney Woods

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.6 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Venn Diagram.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.6 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

How might growing up on a Delta farm be different from growing up in a Piney Woods town?

The Delta is a broad, flat plain in northwestern Mississippi between the Mississippi and Yazoo rivers. For thousands of years, floods left layers of rich soil. Today the Delta is known for large farms of cotton, soybeans, corn, and rice, and for catfish farming in ponds. Towns are spread out across wide fields. The Delta is also famous as a birthplace of the blues.

The Piney Woods covers much of southeastern Mississippi. Its sandy soil is less fertile for crops, but it is excellent for growing pine trees. Lumber and paper mills grew up around cities such as Hattiesburg and Laurel. Forests here also support hunting, outdoor recreation, and wildlife.

	The Delta	Piney Woods	Both
land	very flat	rolling hills	part of Mississippi; rivers
soil	rich alluvial soil	sandy soil	
main uses	row crops, catfish farms	timber, paper, outdoor recreation	agriculture is important
places	Greenville, Clarksdale	Hattiesburg, Laurel	

ACTIVITY · VENN DIAGRAM

How are the two regions alike and different?

You need: paper; two colored pencils.

1. Draw two overlapping circles labeled Delta and Piney Woods.
2. Write at least four details in each outer part.
3. Write at least two shared details in the middle.

4 Write a summary sentence.

Record: your Venn diagram and summary.

★ KEY IDEA

The land and soil of a region shape how people earn a living there.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Why is the Delta good for crops?

Answer: Floods left rich alluvial soil on flat land.

2. What grows well in the Piney Woods?

Answer: pine trees (timber)

3. Name a Piney Woods city.

Answer: Hattiesburg or Laurel

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.6

#	Question	Answer
1	Why is the Delta good for crops?	Floods left rich alluvial soil on flat land.
2	What grows well in the Piney Woods?	pine trees (timber)
3	Name a Piney Woods city.	Hattiesburg or Laurel
4	To tell how things differ	contrast
5	Trees cut for wood	timber
6	Delta land shape	flat
7	Piney Woods soil	sandy
8	One Delta product	cotton, soybeans, rice, corn, or catfish
9	One Piney Woods product	lumber or paper
10	Write a paragraph comparing the two regions. Use a compare word (both, similarly) and a contrast word (however, but).	Answers vary; include land, soil, and work.
11	Explain how soil affects the jobs people have in each region.	Rich Delta soil supports crops; sandy Piney Woods soil supports pine forests and timber.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
Planned for Fri Nov 13
About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 3: Regions — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Flat region with rich river soil	the Delta
2	Region with sandy soil and pine forests	Piney Woods
3	Region with beaches and marshes	Gulf Coast
4	Region with dark, rich soil in the northeast	Black Prairie
5	Name one way the Delta and Piney Woods are alike and one way they are different.	Alike: both are Mississippi regions where natural resources support work. Different: Delta is flat with rich soil for crops; Piney Woods has sandy soil and pine forests.

LESSON 1.7 · TEACHER PLAN
Planned for Tuesday, November 17

Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.7: Natural Resources

Student goal	I can identify Mississippi's natural resources and classify them as renewable or nonrenewable.
Objective	Students classify natural resources.
Standard	C3 D2.Eco.3.3-5 — Identify resources used to produce goods and services.
Date	Tue Nov 17
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 1.7
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Room scan.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and table.
Analyze	10	Model classifying resources.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking renewable means unlimited.

SUPPORT

- Picture sort.

EXTEND

- Visit a recycling center or tree farm.

STUDENT LESSON 1.7 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.7: Natural Resources

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.7 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Resource Hunt.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.7 (Parts B–E).

THINK ABOUT IT

Look around the room. What came from nature: from soil, trees, water, or underground?

Mississippi is rich in natural resources. Some are renewable: forests can be replanted, and fish and farm crops can grow again if they are managed well. Others are nonrenewable: oil and natural gas, found underground in parts of southern Mississippi and offshore in the Gulf, took millions of years to form.

Resource	Renewable?	Used for
fertile soil	renewable if cared for	growing crops
forests	renewable (replanting)	lumber, paper, furniture
water (rivers, groundwater)	renewable	drinking, farming, fishing, transportation
fish and shellfish (Gulf)	renewable if not overfished	food
oil and natural gas	nonrenewable	fuel, energy
sand, gravel, and clay	nonrenewable	building roads and bricks

Conservation helps resources last. Foresters replant trees after harvests, farmers protect soil from erosion, and fishing seasons and limits help keep Gulf fish and shrimp populations healthy.

ACTIVITY · RESOURCE HUNT

Where do the things in your home come from?

You need: paper and a pencil.

1 Find ten objects in your home.

2 For each, name the natural resource it came from (wood, cotton, oil/plastic, metal, sand/glass).

3 Label each resource renewable or nonrenewable.

4 Circle one item you could reuse or recycle.

Record: a three-column chart: Object | Natural resource | Renewable or nonrenewable.

★ KEY IDEA

Natural resources come from nature. Renewable resources can be replaced; nonrenewable ones cannot. Conservation helps them last.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Is a pine forest renewable or nonrenewable?

Answer: renewable

2. Is natural gas renewable?

Answer: no, nonrenewable

3. Name one way to conserve a resource.

Answer: e.g. replant trees, recycle, fishing limits

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.7

#	Question	Answer
1	Is a pine forest renewable or nonrenewable?	renewable
2	Is natural gas renewable?	no, nonrenewable
3	Name one way to conserve a resource.	e.g. replant trees, recycle, fishing limits
4	Something from nature people use	natural resource
5	Careful use of resources	conservation
6	cotton	renewable
7	oil	nonrenewable
8	shrimp	renewable (if managed)
9	gravel	nonrenewable
10	water	renewable
11	timber	renewable

#	Question	Answer
12	Choose one Mississippi resource. Explain how people use it and one way to conserve it.	Answers vary.
13	Why is it important to conserve even renewable resources?	They can run out if used faster than they are replaced.

LESSON 1.8 · TEACHER PLAN
Planned for Thursday, November 19
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.8: Resources and Work in Each Region

Student goal	I can explain how natural resources shape the goods, services, and jobs in different regions.
Objective	Students connect resources to regional economies.
Standard	C3 D2.Eco.3.3-5, D2.Geo.4.3-5 — Identify resources used to produce goods and services; how people adapt to environments.
Date	Thu Nov 19
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Poster paper, markers, workbook Lesson 1.8, Unit 1 Review
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Three workers.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and table.
Analyze	10	Model tracing a product.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook; then the Unit 1 Review.
Exit Ticket	3	Tomorrow (Friday): Unit 1 Test.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Confusing goods and services.

SUPPORT

- Goods = hold it; services = someone does it.

EXTEND

- Visit a local farm, mill, or port online.

STUDENT LESSON 1.8 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.8: Resources and Work in Each Region

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.8 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Regional Economy Poster.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.8 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

A Delta farmer, a Piney Woods mill worker, and a Gulf Coast shrimper all earn a living. What does each one depend on?

The economy of each region grows from its resources. Farmers grow goods in fertile soil. Mill workers turn trees into lumber and paper. Gulf Coast workers catch seafood, build ships, and serve visitors. Agriculture is Mississippi's largest industry, and chickens raised for meat (broilers) are among its most valuable farm products.

Region	Key resources	Goods and services
The Delta	rich soil, water	cotton, soybeans, rice, corn, farm-raised catfish
Piney Woods	pine forests	lumber, paper, wood products
Black Prairie and hills	soil, pasture	cattle, poultry, crops, manufacturing
Gulf Coast	the Gulf, beaches, ports	seafood, shipbuilding, shipping, tourism

LOOK CLOSER · TRACE A PRODUCT

A pine tree becomes a notebook

1 Natural resource: a pine tree grows in the Piney Woods.

2 Producers: loggers harvest it; a paper mill turns it into paper.

3 Services: truck drivers deliver it; a store sells it.

4 Consumer: you buy the notebook.

Answer: One resource creates many jobs on its way to you.

ACTIVITY · REGIONAL ECONOMY POSTER

How does one region earn a living?

You need: poster paper; markers.

1 Choose one region.

2 Show its resources, two goods or services, and two jobs.

3 Draw arrows from each resource to the goods it produces.

4 Present your poster to your family.

Record: your poster and a two-sentence summary.

★ KEY IDEA

Natural resources shape the goods, services, and jobs in each region.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Goods or service: a haircut

Answer: service

2. Goods or service: a bag of rice

Answer: goods

3. Which region is known for shipbuilding and seafood?

Answer: the Gulf Coast

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.8

#	Question	Answer
1	Goods or service: a haircut	service
2	Goods or service: a bag of rice	goods
3	Which region is known for shipbuilding and seafood?	the Gulf Coast
4	Things made or grown to sell	goods
5	Work done for others	services
6	A catfish farm is in which region?	the Delta
7	A paper mill is likely in which region?	the Piney Woods
8	A tour guide provides a...	service
9	Lumber is a...	good

#	Question	Answer
10	Trace a product (cotton T-shirt or shrimp dinner) from resource to you. Name at least three producers.	Answers vary.
11	How does a region's land affect its economy? Give one example.	e.g. Delta soil supports farming jobs.

UNIT REVIEW · ANSWER KEY
Planned for Thu Nov 19 (homework) or as needed
About 40 minutes

Unit 1 Review — Answer Key

Homework or a study session before the test.

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Four map parts	title, compass rose, key, scale
2	Lines that run east–west	latitude
3	Mississippi borders Tennessee to the…	north
4	the Delta	flat, fertile, crops
5	Piney Woods	pine forests, timber
6	Gulf Coast	seafood, shipbuilding, tourism
7	oil: renewable?	no
8	forests: renewable?	yes
9	a doctor's checkup: good or service?	service

UNIT TEST · ANSWER KEY
Planned for Fri Nov 20
About 45 minutes

Unit 1 Test — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Which map part tells what symbols mean?	map key (legend)
2	Which direction is between south and west?	southwest
3	Use the map's scale. About how far is Jackson from Gulfport? (figure)	about 150 miles (accept 130–170)
4	Which coordinates are closest to Jackson? A. 32° N, 90° W B. 32° S, 90° E C. 90° N, 32° W	A. 32° N, 90° W
5	Name the states that border Mississippi.	Tennessee, Alabama, Louisiana, Arkansas
6	What body of water is on Mississippi's southern coast?	Gulf of Mexico
7	Why do most rivers in Mississippi flow south?	The land slopes down from north to south.
8	Which kind of map would best show county boundaries? A. physical B. political C. elevation	B. political
9	Which region has rich alluvial soil?	the Delta
10	Which region is known for pine forests?	Piney Woods
11	Name one Gulf Coast job.	e.g. shrimper, shipbuilder, tour guide
12	Which is a nonrenewable resource? A. timber B. natural gas C. catfish	B. natural gas
13	Goods or service: delivering mail	service
14	Name one way to conserve a natural resource.	e.g. replant trees, recycle, fishing limits
15	Choose two Mississippi regions. Compare their land and explain how the land affects the work people do there.	Rubric: two regions correctly described (1); one similarity (1); one difference (1); clear link between land/resources and jobs (1).

Scoring

Score	What it means / next step
16–18 (85%+)	Mastered.

Score	What it means / next step
13–15	Proficient; review missed skills.
Below 13	Reteach and retest.

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01 Mississippi: Land and Regions

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